INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 003 · HOT

Cohesity

AI Data Security / Data Protection · San Jose, CA · Private (Nvidia-backed; 2026 IPO, ~$17B target)

Nvidia-backed Cohesity hit ~$1.5B ARR after absorbing Veritas and is steering toward a 2026 IPO at a valuation rivalling Rubrik's $17B - with no motorsport presence anywhere and the entire data-security category open on the grid.

83 OPPORTUNITY / 100	TIMING WINDOW	SERIES	RECOMMENDED TEAM	ACTION HORIZON
	HOT	**F1**	**Williams**	**6-10 WKS**

THE CASE

Cohesity is the rare combination our mandate prizes most: an established category leader arriving at a brand-reckoning moment with budget, motive and a clean strategic gap. Following its 2024 merger with Veritas' data-protection business, annual recurring revenue surged to roughly $1.5 billion at a 28% adjusted margin, and the Nvidia-backed company is now steering toward a 2026 IPO with a valuation explicitly benchmarked against its publicly traded peer Rubrik (~$17B). Two things make it a 1440 target rather than just a big company. First, it has never touched motorsport, so an approach now is early - we would not be the hundredth agency in the inbox. Second, the data-security and resilience category - protecting the data that everything else depends on - is entirely unoccupied on the F1 grid, which means Cohesity could define and own it rather than share it. The IPO is the forcing function that turns 'someday' into 'this year'.

WHY NOW

An IPO is the single largest brand-elevation event in a company's life, and the 12 months around it are when leadership spends most deliberately on institutional credibility - exactly the currency a multi-year F1 partnership trades in. Signing around the listing lets Cohesity convert a finance milestone into a global enterprise-brand statement, pre-build the recognition that public investors reward, and lock category exclusivity before any data-protection rival (Rubrik, Veeam, Commvault) recognises the same open lane. The post-Veritas integration narrative also benefits from a single, high-visibility external proof point that the merged company is now one coherent market leader.

SPINOFF UNICORN · NEVER ENTERED · FUNDING EVENT · CATEGORY WHITESPACE · DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY WILLIAMS

Williams is the natural canvas. Its story is a data-and-engineering revival - Atlassian as title partner, Confluent on data streaming - which makes it the grid's most data-literate team and the most credible home for a data-resilience brand. Cohesity would sit beside complementary, non-competing data partners (storage/streaming vs. protection/recovery), reinforcing rather than colliding with the existing roster, and Williams' resurgent, technically-credible narrative gives Cohesity an upward-momentum association in front of the enterprise-IT decision-makers in its hospitality suites.

VALUE TO WILLIAMS — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - a real operational fit, not just signage. A Williams race weekend produces and must safeguard enormous volumes of telemetry, simulation data and proprietary design IP, and any loss or compromise is a competitive catastrophe. That is precisely Cohesity's domain: backup, rapid recovery and ransomware resilience. The partnership can be built around an actual data-protection deployment for the team's race and factory data, giving Williams genuine operational value and a defensible 'we protect the data that wins races' story, while Cohesity gains a marquee reference customer it can name on the IPO roadshow. The exchange is tangible on both sides.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Data Resilience Partner tier on Williams. MINIMUM THREE YEARS - ideally four, to span the IPO and the post-listing brand-build cycle - at an estimated $4-7M/yr. Scope: garage and cockpit branding in the data-security category, hospitality at marquee rounds, digital rights targeting an enterprise-IT audience, a working data-protection deployment for the team, and category exclusivity to keep every data-protection rival off the car.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Carol Carpenter

CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, COHESITY - VERIFIED VIA COHESITY NEWSROOM

Cohesity's first CMO, leading the global marketing organisation. Previously CMO at Unity and CMO at VMware (where her teams drove the multi-cloud repositioning) - a seasoned enterprise brand-builder running exactly the kind of category-defining, IPO-readiness brand programme an F1 partnership would anchor. Co-decision-makers for a spend of this size: CEO Sanjay Poonen (ex-VMware) and the IR/CFO function during the listing window.

OPENING ANGLE

> *"Carol, you've run the brand through a VMware-scale repositioning - you know an IPO is won on credibility, not noise. Data resilience is the one enterprise category nobody on the F1 grid has claimed. Worth 25 minutes to own it before the roadshow locks?"*

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING
18 / 20
Targeting a 2026 IPO - the brand-reckoning moment for a category leader. The Veritas merger (Dec 2024) pushed ARR to ~$1.5B and the company is actively building an institutional-grade brand for the roadshow.

CAPACITY
18 / 20
ARR ~$1.5B at a 28% adjusted margin, Nvidia-backed, with an IPO valuation aimed at public peer Rubrik's ~$17B. Title-adjacent spend is comfortably within reach.

BRAND FIT
17 / 20
Data security, backup and ransomware resilience map cleanly to F1's data-obsessed, zero-failure engineering culture - and no data-protection brand sits anywhere on the grid.

URGENCY
15 / 20
The IPO window is a one-time elevation moment, and public peer Rubrik already raises the category's competitive temperature; a grid presence differentiates the listing.

OPS FIT
15 / 20
MODE A: an F1 team generates and must protect petabytes of telemetry, simulation output and design IP - a genuine, demonstrable data-resilience use case in the garage.

RISKS & COUNTERS

IPO QUIET PERIOD Securities rules may restrict marketing announcements in the weeks around the listing. **Counter:** Negotiate and sign quietly, then activate post-listing; use the roadshow period to build internal consensus rather than to announce.

INTEGRATION FOCUS Post-Veritas integration may absorb leadership attention and budget. **Counter:** Position the deal as the single external proof point that the merged company is now one unified category leader - an integration accelerant, not a distraction.

SOURCES

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- https://strategyofsecurity.com/p/cybersecuritys-ipo-pipeline-2026-and-beyond